Yen-Chieh (David) Liao

Division of Mainland China and East Asian Studies | Graduate Institute of National Development
National Taiwan University
davidycliao@gmail.com davidycliao davidycliao.github.io | *Updated:* Oct. 28, 2026

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

National Taiwan University

Assistant Professor, Graduate Institute of National Development (MA and PhD Programs) — Aug 2026 – Present

University of Birmingham

Research Fellow in NLP at the Centre for Artificial Intelligence in Government — Sep 2024 – July 2026

Affiliate Fellow at the Institute for Data and AI — Jul 2025 – July 2026

University College Dublin

Post-doctoral Researcher at the School of Politics and International Relations — Aug 2023 – Sep 2024

University of Bamberg

Pre-doctoral Researcher at the Chair of Comparative Politics — Dec 2021 – Dec 2022

EDUCATION

University of Essex

PhD in Politics — Oct 2017 – Jan 2023

National Taipei University

BA and MA in Public Administration and Policy

RESEARCH

Publications

2026 Electoral Systems and Geographically-Targeted Oversight: Evidence from Taiwan Legislative Yuan. (with Li Tang) ***Electoral Studies*** [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2025.103026].

2025 Catalysts for Progress? Mapping Policy Insights from Energy Research. ***Energy Research and Social Science***. (with Brian Boyle, Stefan Müller, Sarah King and Robin Rauner) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2025.103955]

2025 官僚「再詮釋」領導人意識形態：以《人民日報》習近平外交思想的評論為例 Bureaucratic Reinterpretation of Leaders' Ideologies: A Case Study of People's Daily's Commentary on Xi Jinping Thought on Diplomacy (in Chinese). ***Mainland China Studies*** 中國大陸研究. (with Yi-Nung Tsai) [https://doi.org/10.30389/MCS.202503_68(1).0003]

2024 (Mis)perception of Party-voter Congruence and Satisfaction with Democracy. ***Political Science Research and Methods***. (with Li Tang and Royce Carroll) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2024.48]

2024 Electoral Reform and Fragmented Polarization: New Evidence from Taiwan Legislative Roll Calls. ***Legislative Studies Quarterly*** [DOI:https://doi.org/10.1111/lsq.12459]

2023 The Role of Rituals in Adversarial Parliaments: An Analysis of Expressions of Collegiality in the British House of Commons. (Invited Contribution) ***Historical Social Research***. 48 (3): 209-234. (with David Beck and Thomas Saalfeld) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.12759/hsr.48.2023.31]

2015 The Rationale for Supporting Nuclear Power: Analysis of Taiwanese Public Opinion Survey. ***International Relations of the Asia-Pacific***. 15 (1): 147–176. (with Xiaochen Su, Chung-li Wu, Tai-De Lee, and Chen Tsao)[DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/irap/lcu019]

Selected Working Papers

AI Survey Respondents as Measurement Instruments: A Pre-Registered Total Survey Error Framework. (with Linette Lim and Slava Jankin) ***Revise and Resubmit at Public Opinion Quarterly***

Electoral Reform and Issue Attention in Legislative Oversight: From SNTV to Mixed-Member Majoritarian System in Taiwan. (with Yu-Ceng Liao and Yi-ting Wang) ***Revise and Resubmit at Electoral Studies***.

Knocking on the Wrong Door: Partisan Canvassing and Asymmetric Belief Updating in Britain. (with Li Tang) ***Under review***

Cross-Lingual Stance Detection in Political Texts: Comparison and Application. (with Stefan Müller) ***Under review***

Multi-Agent LLM Systems for Synthetic Survey Experiments in Ethically Constrained Settings. (with Linette Lim and Slava Jankin) Working Draft ***Under review***

ACADEMIC TRAINING PROGRAMMES

2024 ***ARCHER2 Message Passing Programming with MPI*** (***Edinburgh Parallel Computing Centre***)

2023 ***Oxford Large Language Models for Social Science Workshop*** | **57thEssex Summer School:** Advanced Survey Data Analysis and Survey Experiments

2022 ***56th Essex Summer School***, Introduction to Social Network Analysis

2021 ***Machine Learning Summer School:*** Standard Training Programme | ***55th Essex Summer School:*** Advanced Methods for Text-as-Data–Natural Language Processing; Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation

2019 ***54th Essex Summer School:*** Introduction to Bayesian Analysis for the Social Sciences

2018 ***53rd Essex Summer School:*** Ideal Point Estimation and Scaling Methods; Generalized Linear Models

CODE & OPEN-SOURCE PACKAGES

flaiR: An R wrapper for accessing the Flair NLP library in Python.

legisTaiwan: An R package for accessing real-time Taiwan Legislative Data.

asmcjr: An R Package for Supporting the Book 'Analyzing Spatial Models of Choice and Judgment.

RESEARCH GRANTS & AWARD

2025 APSA First Generation Scholars Travel Grant Award

2023 The Scholarship for Attending Oxford Large Language Models for Social Science Workshop, £300

2021–22 Taiwan Overseas Pioneers Grants of Ministry of Science and Technology Taiwan, USD$32,000

2022 University of Essex Departmental Fund for attending 2022 MPSA, £900

2019 University of Essex Departmental Fund for attending 2019 EPSA, £450

2018 Attendance Scholarships to Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, £250

2017–21 The Government Doctoral Scholarship in Legislative Studies and Comparative Politics, Taiwan's Ministry of Education USD$168,000

CONFERENCES (*: discussant; $^{+}$: Poster)

2026 PolMeth Europe (TCD) | APSA* (Boston) | EPSS (Belfast)

2025 PolMeth Europe (LSE) | PolMeth^{+} (Emory) | APSA* (Vacouver) | EPSA* (Madrid)

2024 COMPTEXT (Amsterdam) | EPSA (Cologne) | APSA* (Philadelphia)

2023 EPSA (Glasgow) | APSA* (LA) | ECPR SG Parliaments (Vienna)

2022 ECPR (Innsbruck) | PolMeth^{+} (WashU) | COMPTEXT (Dublin)

2021 MLSS^{+} (NTU, Taiwan) | APSA (Online)

2019 EPSA (Online) | Asian PolMeth^{+} (Online)

2018 EPSA (Belfast)

JOURNAL REFEREE SERVICE

European Journal of Political Research × 3; *Political Science Review* × 3; *Political Science Research and Methods* × 3; *Journal of Taiwan Politics* × 1; *Legislative Studies Quarterly* × 5; *Government and Opposition* × 1; *Electoral Studies* × 4; *Representation* × 2; *Journal of Politics* × 1; *Research & Politics* × 3; *The Social Science Journal* × 1; *Social Science Computer Review* × 1.

REFERENCES

Prof. Slava Jankin
Executive Director of Data, Talent and AI
Economic and Social Research Council
Chair in Data Science and Government
Director, Centre for AI in Government
University of Birmingham
sjankin.com

Prof. Thomas Saalfeld
Chair of Comparative Politics
University of Bamberg
uni-bamberg.de

Prof. Stefan Müller
School of Politics and International Relations
University College Dublin
muellerstefan.net

Prof. Royce Carroll
Department of Political Science
University of Houston
scholar.google